

IA/FIST Lab Equipment Booking Portal

User Manual

For: Users (students and researchers), Operators, Professors and Administrators

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1. About This Manual

The IA/FIST Lab Equipment Booking Portal is a web site used to book time on the shared equipment of the lab. This manual explains, step by step, how each type of person uses the portal. Read the chapter for your own role. Chapter 2 is useful for everyone.

1.1 Who does what

Role	Who	Main tasks
User	Student or researcher	Register, get the guide confirmation, book equipment slots, see booking history, confirm that results were collected.
Operator	Lab technician who runs the equipment	See the bookings of own equipment, update the analysis status, block dates, switch equipment on or off, add equipment.
Professor	Guide of the students	Confirm new students, see the students, see the booking history of each student, remove a student whose tenure is over.
Admin	Portal administrator (also the super admin)	Add professors and equipment, give roles, delete users, block dates, post notifications.

1.2 Words used in this manual

Word	Meaning
Guide	The professor under whom a student or researcher works. Chosen at registration.
Slot	One hour of equipment time on one day, for example 9AM-10AM.
Booking period	A fixed period of 14 days for which booking is open. A new period opens every second Wednesday at 8:30 AM Indian time.
Quota	The number of bookings allowed for one equipment in one booking period for all students of the same guide together.
Samples per slot	The largest number of samples that can be run in one slot. It is shown on the Information page as a guide for planning.
Booking ID	A six digit number given to every booked slot. Quote it when you contact the operator.

1.3 Important rules at a glance

- A new account cannot be used until the guide confirms it by email.
- Saturday and Sunday are holidays and cannot be booked.
- Only the dates of the current 14 day booking period can be booked.
- The first person to confirm a slot gets it. A booked slot cannot be booked again by anyone else.
- Each guide has a limited number of bookings per equipment for every booking period. All students of that guide share it.
- Equipment that is marked as not functioning cannot be selected.

2. Common Tasks for Everyone

2.1 Open the portal

Open the web address of the portal that the lab has given you, in a modern web browser on a computer, tablet or phone. The first page is the Log In page.

2.2 Log in

- 1 On the Log In card, type your Email and Password.
- 2 Press Log In. The eye icon at the end of the password box shows or hides the password.
- 3 You are taken to the Home page. If you are a professor, use the link **Click Here For Professor's Login** on the same card instead (chapter 5).
- 4 You stay logged in for 3 days on the same browser unless you press Log Out.

If the message *Invalid credentials* appears, the email or password is wrong. If the message says you are not verified yet, your guide has not yet confirmed your registration (section 3.2).

2.3 Log out

Press the red **Log Out** button at the right end of the top menu. Always log out when you use a shared computer.

2.4 Forgotten password

- 1 On the Log In card press **Forgot password?**.
- 2 Type the email you used at registration and press Submit. The page always shows a message that a link was sent.
- 3 Open the email with the subject *Password Reset Request* and press **Update Password**.
- 4 Type the new password twice and press Submit. When it is accepted you are taken to the Log In page.
- 5 The new password must have at least 6 characters, with one lower case letter, one upper case letter, one digit and one special character from @ \$! % * ? & #.

2.5 Top menu

The top menu changes with the role. On a phone, open it with the button at the top left. Every role also has the links Acknowledgement, About and Information.

Role	Menu links
User	Home, My Booking
Operator	Home, Block Booking, Alter Equipment Status, Operator Dashboard, Add Equipment, My Booking
TA	Home, Operator Dashboard
Admin and Super admin	Home, Add Equipment, Add Professor, All Users, Privilege, Block Booking, Alter Equipment Status, Notification
Professor	Professor Dashboard

2.6 Information, About, Acknowledgement and contact

- **Information** lists every piece of equipment with its model, short guidelines, the maximum samples per slot, the maximum bookings per two weeks and the name, email and phone number of the operator. Read it before you book.
- **About** and **Acknowledgement** give background information on the portal.
- The footer has a link for a code base request. It opens a form where you type your email and your message and press **Submit Request**. The message is sent by email to the portal team.

3. User Manual: Student and Researcher

3.1 Register

Before you start, make sure your guide is already registered in the portal. If your guide is not in the list, ask the administrator to add the professor first.

- 1 On the Log In card, press **Sign Up** at the bottom. The card changes to the Sign Up form.
- 2 Fill in: First name, Last name, Institute ID, Institute Email, Select Guide, Contact Number, Password and Confirm Password.
- 3 Press **Sign Up**.
- 4 A page opens with the message that a request has been sent to your guide. Contact your guide and ask them to confirm.

Rules for the form

Field	What to type
First name and Last name	Letters only. No spaces, digits or symbols.
Institute ID	Digits only.
Institute Email	Your institute email address. It must not be used by another account.
Select Guide	Choose your professor from the list.
Contact Number	Start with +91 and then 10 digits, with no spaces. Example: +919876543210
Password	At least 6 characters, with one lower case letter, one upper case letter, one digit and one special character from @ \$! % * ? & #.
Confirm Password	Type the same password again. If they differ, the message Passwords do not match appears.

Note: If the email is already registered, the message User already exists appears. If a rule is broken, a red message under the title Sign Up tells you what to correct.

3.2 Guide confirmation

As soon as you register, the system sends an email to your guide. The email says that you are asking for access and has a button to confirm. When the guide presses the button, your account becomes active.

- You do not need to do anything else, but you must ask your guide to check the email (also the spam folder).
- If you try to log in before the confirmation, you will see the message that you are not verified yet.
- After the confirmation you can log in normally.
- If the guide has lost the email, contact the portal team through the contact form or the administrator.

3.3 Home page

After you log in, the Home page opens. It has:

- A line of scrolling notices, when notices have been posted.
- The button **Select Equipment**, which opens a list of the equipment that is working.
- The name of the selected equipment and the button **Continue**.

- A list of equipment that is not functioning. These cannot be selected until the operator makes them available again.

3.4 Book equipment

Steps

- 1 On the Home page press **Select Equipment** and pick the equipment. Press **Continue**.
- 2 The booking table opens. The columns are the 14 dates of the current booking period. The rows are the time slots: 9AM-10AM, 10AM-11AM, 11AM-12PM, 12PM-1PM, 2PM-3PM, 3PM-4PM and 4PM-5PM. The table can be scrolled sideways.
- 3 Find a cell that shows **Book** and click it. The cell changes to **Selected**. You can select several slots.
- 4 Check your selection, then press the green **Continue** button under the table.
- 5 A message at the top right tells you the result. *Booking successful.* means all selected slots are booked. The cells now show Booked.

What the cells show

Cell text	Meaning	Can you click it?
Book	The slot is free.	Yes
Selected	You have chosen it but not yet confirmed it.	Not again
Booked	Someone has already booked this slot (it may be you).	No
Holiday	Saturday or Sunday.	No
Public Holiday, Equipment Not Working, Professor Booking or External User	The operator or admin has blocked this date for that reason.	No
Closed without booking	The time of the slot has already passed.	No

Booking rules

- You can book only the 14 dates shown. A new period opens on Wednesday at 8:30 AM.
- Your guide has a limit of bookings for each equipment in the period. If the limit is used up by you and the other students of your guide, the message *Faculty quota exhausted* is shown and nothing is booked.
- If another user books one of your selected slots a moment before you, the message *Slot already booked for the date at the time* is shown and none of your selected slots is booked. Reload the page, choose other slots and try again.
- Follow the samples per slot limit and the guidelines given on the Information page.
- A slot you clicked by mistake cannot be unselected. Reload the page (or return to Home and open the equipment again) to clear the selection before you press Continue.

Note: Bookings are given strictly first come first served. Book early to get the slot you need.

3.5 See booking history and confirm results

- 1 Press **My Booking** in the top menu.
- 2 The table lists all your bookings with: Equipment name, Date of booking, Slot Date, Slot Time, Booking ID, Operator Status Confirmation and Student Confirmation.
- 3 After you have collected your results from the operator, press **Complete Booking** on that row. The Student Confirmation changes to *Results collected* and the button shows Completed.

Operator status	Meaning
booking reserved	Slot is booked. The operator has not yet updated it.
in progress	Your analysis is being done.
completed	Analysis is finished.
sample issue	There was a problem with your sample. Contact the operator.
technical issue	The equipment had a problem. Contact the operator.
student was absent on slot time	You did not come during the slot.

The table shows 10 rows per page. Use the page controls at the bottom to see older bookings.

3.6 Common problems

Problem	What to do
I cannot log in and it says I am not verified.	Ask your guide to press the confirm button in the email.
My guide is not in the list at sign up.	Ask the administrator to add your guide.
The equipment I need is not in the Home list.	It is marked as not functioning. Contact the operator, whose details are on the Information page.
All cells in a date show one reason text.	That date is blocked (holiday or maintenance). Choose another date.
Faculty quota exhausted.	Your guide's bookings for this equipment are used up for this period. Try again in the next period or ask your guide.
Slot already booked.	Somebody booked it first. Reload and choose another slot.
The old dates are gone from the table.	The booking period changed. Your old bookings are still in My Booking.

4. Operator Manual

An operator is a lab technician who runs one or more pieces of equipment. The administrator gives you the Operator role and assigns your equipment. After the role is given, log out and log in again so that the new menu appears. The operator menu has: Home, Block Booking, Alter Equipment Status, Operator Dashboard, Add Equipment and My Booking.

An operator can also book equipment like a user through Home and can see personal bookings under My Booking (chapter 3).

4.1 See and serve the bookings (Operator Dashboard)

Bookings are made on a first come first served basis: the first person to confirm a slot receives it and nobody else can take it. The Operator Dashboard shows all bookings for the equipment assigned to you, so that you can serve the users in slot order.

- 1 Press **Operator Dashboard** in the menu.
- 2 The table *Equipment Slot Booking History* lists the bookings. The columns are: Student Name, Student Ins. Id, Equipment name, Date of booking, Slot Date, Slot Time, Booking ID, Student Confirmation, Operator Status Confirmation, Update Result Status and Don't Show.
- 3 To find a booking quickly, type the number in the box **Search by Booking ID**.
- 4 To put the bookings in date order, click the column heading Slot Date (click again to reverse). You can sort other columns the same way.
- 5 The table shows 10 rows per page. Use the controls at the bottom for more pages.

Note: Only bookings for the equipment assigned to you are shown. If the table is empty, check with the administrator that you are set as the operator of the equipment.

4.2 Update the status of a booking

- 1 On the row of the booking, press **Update Result Status**.
- 2 In the page *Update Booking Status*, open the list **Select Status** and choose one value.
- 3 Press **Update Status**. The message *Booking Status updated successfully*. appears.
- 4 The user sees the new status in My Booking.

Status	Use it when
in progress	You have started the analysis.
completed	The analysis is finished and the results are ready.
sample issue	The sample cannot be analysed or is wrong.
technical issue	The equipment or method failed.
student was absent on slot time	The user did not come during the slot.

4.3 Hide a finished booking (Don't Show)

Press **Don't Show** on a row to remove it from your dashboard, for example to keep the list short. A window asks *Are you sure, you will not be able to see it again?* Press **Continue** to hide it or **Cancel** to keep it. Hidden rows cannot be brought back from the portal. The user still sees the booking in their history.

4.4 Block a date (holiday, maintenance and so on)

Use this when the equipment cannot be booked on a certain day. Once a date is blocked, users cannot select any slot on that date and they see the reason on the booking table.

- 1 Press **Block Booking** in the menu.
- 2 In the card *Select Details*, choose the reason: Public Holiday, Equipment Not Working, Professor Booking or External User.
- 3 Choose the month and then the date (1 to 31).
- 4 Press **Set Blocking**. The date appears in the list below the form.

To remove a block, find the date in the list, press **Delete** on its row and confirm with Continue.

Note: A block applies to all equipment, not only one machine, and it repeats every year on the same month and day. When a block is no longer needed (for example after a one time maintenance), delete it. Saturdays and Sundays are already treated as holidays and do not need blocking. The blocking works on the booking screen, so ask users to reload the page after you add or remove a block.

4.5 Switch equipment off or on (Alter Equipment Status)

When equipment is out of order, hide it so that nobody can select it on the Home page.

- 1 Press **Alter Equipment Status** in the menu.
- 2 In the card *Select Equipment*, choose the equipment.
- 3 Press **Make Equipment Invisible**. The equipment moves to the list of invisible equipment and users can no longer select it.
- 4 When it is repaired, find it in the list of invisible equipment and press **Make Visible**.

Bookings that were already made are not removed by this action. Inform the affected users, and use Block Booking for the days of the repair if needed.

4.6 Add equipment

Operators and administrators can add equipment. Double check the details, because users see them on the Information page.

- 1 Press **Add Equipment** in the menu.
- 2 Fill in the form *Insert Details*: Equipment Name; Equipment Model (name with model, company and country, for example GC-MS 11256, Agilent, USA); Guideline (short instructions, up to 600 characters); Max. Samples per slot; Max. Bookings (2 weeks); and the operator (select from the list of operators by email).
- 3 Press the submit button at the bottom of the card. The message *Equipment Added Successfully* appears and the equipment is added to the *List of Equipment* below.
- 4 To remove equipment, press **Delete** on its row in the list and confirm.

Max. Bookings (2 weeks) is the quota for each guide, that is, how many slots the students of one guide together may book on this equipment in one booking period.

4.7 Common problems

Problem	What to do
The dashboard is empty.	No one has booked your equipment yet, or you are not set as the operator of the equipment. Ask the administrator.
A user says the slot is taken.	Search the Booking ID or slot on the dashboard. Each slot can have only one booking.
I hid a booking by mistake.	It cannot be restored from the portal. The booking data is still in the database. Ask the administrator.
The new menu does not show.	Log out and log in again after your role is changed.

5. Professor Manual

The Professor Portal is for guides. Professors are registered by the administrator. You do not sign up by yourself.

5.1 Get your login details

When the administrator registers you, the system sends an email with the subject *Credentials for accessing IA lab professors portal*. It contains your login email and a temporary password. Keep the email safe and change the password soon.

5.2 Log in

- 1 Open the portal and, on the Log In card, press **Click Here For Professor's Login**.
- 2 Type your Email and Password and press Log In.
- 3 The Professor Dashboard opens. Your menu has the link Professor Dashboard only (and the Acknowledgement, About and Information links).

5.3 Change the temporary password

- 1 On the professor login page press the forgot password link, which opens a page asking for your email.
- 2 Type your registered email and press Submit.
- 3 Open the email *Password Reset Request For Professors* and press **Update Password**.
- 4 Type the new password twice and press Submit. Then log in again with the new password.
- 5 The password must have at least 6 characters, with one lower case letter, one upper case letter, one digit and one special character from @ \$! % * ? & #.

Note: At the time of writing, the final step of the professor password reset may fail because of a known fault in the system (see the technical documentation, section 7.3). If the message does not say that the password was updated, contact the administrator, who can register the account again with a new password.

5.4 Confirm a new student

When a student registers with you as the guide, you receive an email with the subject *(student name) is requesting to access IA lab booking portal*.

- 1 Read the email. By pressing the button you confirm that the student works under your supervision and you allow the student to use the lab equipment. You also get access to view the equipment used by your students in the Professors Portal.
- 2 Press the button **Confirm Access to (student name)**.
- 3 A page opens with a message that you have granted permission. The student can now log in.
- 4 If you do not know the student, do not press the button and ignore the email.

5.5 See your students

The Professor Dashboard lists all the students who selected you as their guide. For each student it shows: Student Institute ID, First Name, Last Name, Email and Mobile Number. It also has two buttons: **See bookings** and **Delete**.

5.6 See the booking history and activity of a student

- 1 On the Professor Dashboard, press **See bookings** on the row of the student.
- 2 A page opens with the table of that student's bookings under you: Booked Equipment Name, Date of Booking, Slot Date and Slot Time.
- 3 Go back to the dashboard using the browser back button.

Use this to follow how your students use the equipment and to check the use of your booking quota.

5.7 Remove a student whose tenure is over

- 1 On the Professor Dashboard, press **Delete** on the row of the student.
- 2 A window asks for confirmation and warns that the student profile will be deleted permanently.
- 3 Press **Yes, Delete**. The student is removed from the list and can no longer log in.
- 4 Press Cancel if you do not want to delete.

Note: Deleting a student cannot be undone. Look at the booking history first if you need a record. If the student needs to come back, they must register again.

5.8 Common problems

Problem	What to do
I did not get the credentials email.	Check the spam folder, then ask the administrator to check the email address.
A student is not in my list.	The student chose another guide at registration.
I did not get a confirmation email for a student.	Check the spam folder. The email comes from the portal email account. If it is missing, ask the student to contact the portal team.
Invalid credentials.	Email or password is wrong. Use the forgot password option or contact the administrator.

6. Administrator Manual

The administrator has the role Admin or Super admin. Both have the same menu: Home, Add Equipment, Add Professor, All Users, Privilege, Block Booking, Alter Equipment Status and Notification. The super admin account is created automatically when the system is first installed, and its role cannot be changed from the portal.

6.1 Set up order for a new installation

- 1 Log in with the super admin account and change its password at once (use Forgot password).
- 2 Add the professors (section 6.2).
- 3 Ask the operators to register as normal users. After their guides confirm them, give them the Operator role (section 6.4).
- 4 Add the equipment and select the operator of each (section 6.3).
- 5 Add known holidays under Block Booking (section 6.6).
- 6 Tell the students to register.

6.2 Add a professor

- 1 Press **Add Professor**.
- 2 In the card *Insert Profile Details* fill: First name, Last name, email (IITR), password, Lab name and Lab room Number.
- 3 Press the submit button. The message *Professor profile created successfully* appears.
- 4 The system emails the professor the login email and the password you typed, so tell the professor to change it after the first login.

Rules

Field	Rule
First name and Last name	Letters only, no spaces or symbols. Do not type Dr. because the system adds it automatically to the first name.
Email	Must be an iitr.ac.in address (the text says @ch.iitr.ac.in). Must not already exist.
Password	At least 6 characters, with one lower case letter, one upper case letter, one digit and one special character from @ \$! % * ? & #.
Lab name	Optional. Letters, digits and spaces.
Lab room Number	Optional. Letters, digits and hyphen.

The list *List of Professors* below the form shows all professors. To remove a professor, press **Delete** and confirm. Do this only when the professor has left and has no active students, because the students choose their guide from this list.

6.3 Add equipment

The steps are the same as in section 4.6. The administrator can add and delete equipment. Before you add equipment, make sure the operator already has the Operator role, or the operator will not appear in the list. The operator name, email and phone number are copied to the equipment at the time it is added.

6.4 See users, give roles and delete users

All Users

Press **All Users** to see every registered user with Institute ID, First Name, Last Name, Email, Guide ID and Mobile Number. To remove a user, press **Delete** on the row and confirm. Admin accounts cannot be deleted here.

Privilege (change role)

- 1 Press **Privilege**.
- 2 Select the user in the first list.
- 3 Select the role: User, Operator, TA, Admin (the list also shows Professor, but professors must be created with Add Professor, so do not use that option).
- 4 Press **Update Role**. The message *User role updated successfully.* appears.
- 5 Tell the person to log out and log in again.

The role of the super admin cannot be changed. Give the Admin role only to trusted persons, because admins can delete users and equipment.

6.5 Block dates and change equipment status

The admin menu has the same Block Booking and Alter Equipment Status pages as the operator. Use them as described in sections 4.4 and 4.5. Blocks apply to all equipment and repeat every year.

6.6 Post notifications

- 1 Press **Notification**.
- 2 Type the message in the box *Notification Message*.
- 3 Press **Send Notification**. The message appears in the list below and scrolls on the Home page.
- 4 To remove a message, press **Delete** on its row and confirm.

Note: In the present version, a notification is displayed on the Home page of the account that posted it. If the notices must be shown to all users, ask the developer to change this (technical documentation, section 7.3, item 10).

6.7 Yearly clean up of old data

The system has a page to delete the users of an old year and their bookings. There is no link to it in the menu. A developer can open it at the address `/deleteOldData`. On this page you type a four digit year and confirm. All users created in that year and their bookings are deleted, except Admin and Super admin accounts. This cannot be undone. Take a database backup before you use it, and confirm with the lab before doing it.

6.8 Routine checklist

When	Task
Start of each semester or year	Add new professors. Remove professors who left. Check the operator of every equipment. Review the Max. Bookings (2 weeks) of each equipment.
Every booking period (every second Wednesday)	Check that holidays and maintenance days of the coming two weeks are blocked. Post a notification if there is news.
When equipment fails	Use Alter Equipment Status and Block Booking, and post a notification.
When a new operator joins	Register as a user, get the guide confirmation, then give the Operator role and assign the equipment.
End of the year	Ask professors to remove students who have left. Do the clean up of old data after a backup.
Regularly	Back up the database. Keep the email account password and the system secret safe.

6.9 Common problems

Problem	What to do
A student says the guide is missing at sign up.	Add the professor with Add Professor.
A student never got verified.	Ask the guide to check the email, or ask the guide to confirm again. If the email was lost the student may need to register again after their old record is deleted in All Users.
The operator is not in the Add Equipment list.	Give the person the Operator role in Privilege. Only users with the Operator role are listed.
Emails are not arriving.	Ask the developer to check the email account settings and password of the portal, and check the spam folder.
A wrong date was blocked.	Open Block Booking, find the date in the list and press Delete.

End of user manual.